

IES Applicant Assistant — Submission Dossier

Prototype: Interactive Applicant Orientation & Fit Checker Tool for the International Excellence Scholarship (IES)

CANDIDATE / AUTHOR

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SUBMISSION TASK CODE

Arman_Ogannisian_IT_EligibilityTool.pdf

TARGET ORGANIZATION

Copernicus Berlin e.V. (Berlin, Germany)

TECHNICAL STACK

React 18, TypeScript, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Lucide Icons

Core Motto: "Study abroad is only the beginning."

Guiding Philosophy: Exchange Study + International Cohort + Hands-on Community Engagement.

1. Executive Summary & Problem Statement

When university students first discover the International Excellence Scholarship (IES), they often encounter dense institutional documentation and assume it is a traditional lecture-only exchange programme. Consequently, capable candidates fail to appreciate the essential **Community Engagement** pillar, or hesitate to apply due to uncertainty about their skills and eligibility.

The **IES Applicant Assistant** solves this problem by structuring student discovery into an intuitive, 5-stage journey:

1. **01 Discover:** Grasp the programme philosophy within 15 seconds.
2. **02 Explore:** Understand the 3 foundational pillars (Exchange Study, International Community, Community Engagement).
3. **03 Check:** Complete an interactive, multi-step Fit Checker assessing motivation and matching personal skills.
4. **04 Learn:** Review verified FAQs and clarify questions using the controlled AI Knowledge Assistant.
5. **05 Apply:** Seamlessly transition to the official Copernicus Berlin portal (copernicusberlin.org/en).

2. Key Implemented Features

Interactive Fit Checker

4-step questionnaire evaluating university enrollment, international study motivation, community willingness, and specialized skill areas with personalized track recommendations.

Controlled AI Assistant

Safe, zero-hallucination conversational prototype grounded strictly in approved Copernicus documentation with source citations and automatic fallbacks.

Real-Time Analytics HUD

In-app developer drawer tracking key applicant funnel KPIs (start/completion rates, official portal clicks, session duration) in real time.

Strict Factual Safeguards

Zero invented scholarship amounts, dates, or institutional claims. Clear visual badges distinguish verified facts from cycle-specific consultations.

3. UX Decisions & Brand Discipline

- **Authentic Brand Identity:** Implemented Copernicus Berlin’s signature energetic orange (#F37021) and academic navy (#1A2A44) on warm editorial cream (#FDFBF7).
- **Mobile-First Architecture:** Optimized for university students discovering the scholarship via mobile browsers or social media (TikTok, Instagram).
- **Progressive Disclosure:** Prevents cognitive fatigue by presenting information in digestible steps rather than overwhelming walls of legal text.
- **Explicit Disclaimers:** Prominently displays: *“This tool is for informational guidance only and does not determine official eligibility. Please consult the official IES information before applying.”*

4. Technical Quality & Architecture

Layer	Implementation	Rationale
Frontend Core	React 18 + TypeScript 5.6	Type-safe, robust component architecture with zero runtime type errors.
Styling	Tailwind CSS 3.4	Custom branded design tokens with fluid responsive breakpoints.
Build Engine	Vite 5.4	Instant HMR in development and optimized, minified production bundling.
Content Decoupling	src/data/*.ts	All text, links, and questions are configured separately so Copernicus Berlin staff can update content without modifying code.
Analytics Abstraction	src/utils/analytics.ts	Event-driven pub/sub architecture supporting seamless future connection to Matomo, PostHog, or GA4.

5. Submission Google Drive Checklist

- To submit this project to the Copernicus Berlin selection committee, follow these instructions:
1. Print or save this dossier as Arman_Ogannisian_IT_EligibilityTool.pdf.
 2. Place all materials (this PDF, screenshots, repository link, and live demo link) into a dedicated Google Drive folder.
 3. Set the Google Drive sharing permissions to **“Anyone with the link can view”** so the selection team can inspect files without permission barriers.

6. AI Usage Disclosure

In compliance with Copernicus Berlin’s academic integrity guidelines: AI tools were used for technical assistance (code scaffolding, type checking, CSS utility refinement). The concept, product direction, information architecture, UX decisions, scoring logic, and final validation were authored and reviewed by the applicant.

